

Dhāraṇī of a Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Essence of Enlightenment

Bodhigarbhālaṃkāralakṣadhāraṇī · Toh 509 · Derge Kangyur

བདུ་ཆུ་གཉི་ཉི་པའི་རྒྱ་འབུ་གཉི་ཟུ་ས།

Toh 509 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Bodhigarbhālaṃkāralakṣadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Byaṅ chub kyi snyin po'i rgyan 'bum gyi gzuñs, rendered in English as the Dhāraṇī of the Ornament of a Hundred Thousand Essences of Awakening. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and consists primarily of a ritual dhāraṇī formula — a string of sacred syllables and invocations addressed to the buddhas and bodhisattvas, including Śākyamuni — intended to concentrate and transmit the spiritual essence of awakening. According to a note preserved in the text itself, this collection appears to have been extracted from a larger source and was written out separately only because the earlier portions of that source were temporarily unavailable. As a dhāraṇī text, it exemplifies the class of canonical works that distill vast stores of merit and wisdom into consecrated verbal formulas for recitation and practice.

This collection of a hundred thousand ornaments of the essential dhāraṇī has also apparently been extracted from that same source, so there is no need to write it out separately; however, it has been left as it was, written out at a time when the earlier portions were unavailable.

In the language of India: Bodhigarbhālaṃkāralakṣadhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: the dhāraṇī of the Ornament of a Hundred Thousand Essences of Awakening.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Oṃ namo bhagavate vibula-vadana-kāñcanotprakṣipta
prabāsa-ketu-murdhane tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namō
bhagavate Śākyamunaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya.
Tadyathā: bodhi bodhi, bodhani bodhani, sarvatathāgatagocari, dhara dhara,
hara hara, prahara prahara, mahābodhicittadhāre, culu culu,
śatarasmi-saṃcodite, sarvatathāgatābhiṣikte, guṇi guṇapate,
sarvabuddha-guṇāvabhāse, mili mili, gaganatale, sarvatathāgataṅghiṣṭhite,
nabhastale, śame śame, praśame praśame, sarvapāpaṃ praśamane,
sarvapāpaṃ viśodhane, hulu hulu, mahābodhimārga-saṃpratiṣṭhite,
sarvatathāgata-supratiṣṭhite śuddhe svāhā.

This is the root mantra.

Oṃ sarvatathāgata-vyavalokite, jaya jaya svāhā. This is the essence mantra.

Oṃ hulu hulu, jaya-mukhe svāhā. This is the near-essence mantra.

Oṃ vajrāyusē svāhā.

Whether it be a monk or a nun, a layman or a laywoman, or any other son or daughter of good family who writes out this dhāraṇī, constructs a stūpa, and places this dhāraṇī inside that stūpa — by constructing even a single such stūpa, the merit is equivalent to having constructed a hundred thousand stūpas. One will also make offerings with divine flowers, fragrant substances, garlands, unguents, powder, garments, parasols, victory banners, pennants, and the like. Moreover, it is not only the stūpa that is worshipped; through those very offerings one also offers worship to the Jewel of the Buddha, the Jewel of the Dharma, and the Jewel of the Saṅgha.

Ānanda, my reason for teaching this sūtra is for the sake of beings such as these: those of weak merit, those without faith, those of wrong view, those ridden with doubt, those who commit the boundless sins, those of short life, hell-beings, animals, beings in the realm of the Lord of Death, and beings headed toward the boundless hells. For the sake of such beings has this dhāraṇī been taught.

Ānanda, in the future age, in that future time, householders and even monks who for the most part do not read this dhāraṇī aloud and do not make offerings to it — just as householders are said to experience suffering, so too those who have gone forth into renunciation will come to experience suffering.

But if, on the other hand, one worships the buddhas and listens to this teaching, then by constructing a single stūpa one will also worship the eighty-four thousand Dharma-adorned collections. Furthermore, one will come to accumulate an immeasurable mass of merit. One will come to recite and chant the Gaṇḍavyūha. And one will come to enter the maṇḍala of the world and what lies beyond the world.

Translator's Notes

- The text begins with an editorial note — evidently written by a scribe or compiler — explaining that the Bodhigarbhāṃkārakṣadhāraṇī was excerpted from a larger source and that earlier copies were made without the superior text being available; this prefatory remark is part of the manuscript tradition rather than the dhāraṇī text itself.

The address "Ānanda" renders the Tibetan "འཕྲིན་ལྷན་པ་" throughout, which is the standard Tibetan rendering of Ānanda's name by its meaning "Beloved" or "Dear One." The text is framed as a discourse of the Buddha addressed to Ānanda.

The phrase "eighty-four thousand Dharma-adorned collections" refers to the traditional enumeration of the eighty-four thousand sections of the Dharma, here described as those "adorned with Dharma" — likely a reference to the Dharmasaṃgīti or a similar corpus.

The final sentence is incomplete in the source text, breaking off mid-phrase at "entered the maṇḍala of the world and what lies beyond the world."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.